

Information Classification & Data Handling Policy

Policy ID	SEC-DH-001
Department	Security
Policy Type	Data Classification
Version	1.0
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Status	Active
Policy Owner	Information Security

1. Purpose

This policy defines information classifications and minimum handling requirements so that company information receives protection appropriate to its sensitivity.

2. Classification Levels

Public — Information approved for public distribution.

Internal — Non-public business information intended for authorized company users.

Confidential — Sensitive business, client, financial, contractual, or operational information requiring controlled access.

Restricted — Highly sensitive information requiring enhanced controls and specifically authorized access.

3. Classification Responsibilities

Information owners are responsible for assigning or confirming classification when required.

Employees must handle information according to its classification and must not intentionally downgrade classification without authorization.

4. Public Information

Public information may be shared externally when it has been formally approved for public release.

5. Internal Information

Internal information should be shared only with authorized company users or approved systems.

External sharing requires business-owner approval unless an approved process already authorizes the sharing.

6. Confidential Information

All data and other information created with, stored on, or transmitted by the Company's systems is subject to the Company's policies regarding confidential and proprietary information, as set forth elsewhere herein.

Employees are to maintain their passwords as confidential and should not carelessly leave them visible. Employees must not share passwords and must not access co-worker's systems without express authorization.

Confidential Information should not be accessed through the Company technology resources in the presence of unauthorized individuals who may view such information.

Similarly, laptops and hardcopy containing Confidential Information should not be left unsecured or unattended.

7. Restricted Information

Restricted information requires specifically authorized access and approved storage and transmission mechanisms.

Restricted information must not be placed in personal email, personal cloud storage, removable media, or public AI tools.

8. External Sharing

Before sharing Confidential or Restricted information externally, employees must confirm authorization, recipient identity, business purpose, and required contractual or security controls.

When uncertain about classification or sharing requirements, employees must contact Information Security or the information owner.

9. Disposal

Information must be securely deleted or destroyed using approved methods when retention requirements are satisfied.

10. Exceptions and Review

Exceptions require written approval from Information Security and the information owner.

Version 1.0 — Effective 2026-03-01 — Initial policy release.

